Digital Madrasa: An Integrated Application That Will Manage Madrasas in Kenya

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This project is submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of Bachelor of Science in Computer Science.

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This system project has been submitted for examination with my approval as university supervisor.

Supervisor's signature:

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DEDICATION

I dedicate this work to my beloved parents and family for their love, prayers and support throughout my studies, and to my friends, mentors and siblings for their encouragement. I also dedicate it to the Muslim community of Kenya, especially the students, teachers and parents of our duksi and madrasas. May this work contribute in a small way to the teaching and memorisation of the Holy Quran.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

All praise is due to Allah (SWT) for granting me health, strength and perseverance to complete this project.

I sincerely thank my supervisor, [SUPERVISOR NAME], for the guidance and feedback given throughout the project. I thank my parents and family for their prayers, encouragement and support, and my relatives, friends and classmates for their motivation.

I am grateful to Umma University and the School of Business and Technology for the learning environment that made this work possible. May Allah (SWT) reward all who supported me. Ameen.

ABSTRACT

Madrasas and duksi in Kenya teach Quran recitation and memorisation to large numbers of children, but they are administered informally: attendance, memorisation progress and fees are recorded in exercise books or not at all, parents have little reliable information about their children, and fee payments are not linked to invoices. Existing Quran applications serve individual learners, while school management systems have no Quran-specific functions. This project developed the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application, an integrated mobile application for managing madrasas in Kenya, implemented under the brand ILMORA (Integrated Qur'an & Madrasa Learning).

The system was developed using the Agile methodology with React Native (Expo) and TypeScript for the mobile application and Supabase (PostgreSQL, authentication, storage and Edge Functions) for the backend. Each madrasa is a separate tenant whose records are protected by Row Level Security on every table. The application serves madrasa owners, teachers, parents and students, and provides student admission, classes, manual and QR-code attendance, memorisation tracking, recitation recording with teacher review, parent–child linking approved by the madrasa, AI recitation feedback given only with a parent's consent, master-reciter comparison, hifz streaks and badges, a live reading room with scheduled lessons, a teacher-chosen Quran video library, fee invoicing with M-Pesa and card payment, parent–teacher messaging, offline attendance, notifications, and an interface in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic.

Unit, functional and user interface testing showed that the core features work as required and that users cannot reach records outside their madrasa or role: all 185 unit tests and 78 functional test cases passed, 21 database suites proved 145 security guarantees, and the installed app passed 30 of 31 interface checks. M-Pesa runs on Safaricom's Daraja sandbox, while card, e-mail and SMS run on mock providers until live credentials are configured. The project shows that a secure, integrated madrasa management application for Kenya is feasible.

Keywords: Digital Madrasa, ILMORA, madrasa management, Quran memorisation, mobile application, React Native, Supabase, M-Pesa, Kenya.

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CHAPTER ONE

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The Holy Quran is memorised and recited by Muslims as the word of Allah (SWT), and its memorisation (Hifz) together with the rules of correct recitation (tajweed) has been passed down through Quranic schools for centuries. Boyle (2004) describes these schools as institutions that both preserve a religious tradition and adapt to the societies around them. In Kenya, and particularly in the Coast, North Eastern and Nairobi regions, they are known as duksi or madrasa. They meet in mosques, homes and community buildings, admit children from about four years of age and teach recitation, memorisation and basic religious knowledge. Mwaura, Sylva and Malmberg (2008) evaluated the community Madrasa preschool programme in Kenya, Uganda and Zanzibar and found measurable cognitive benefits for participating children, showing that madrasa-based education can be structured and assessed.

The status of these institutions is changing. Ndzovu (2023) identifies the absence of a standardised syllabus and record-keeping as recurring concerns of the traditional madrassa system in Kenya, and in June 2026 the national government announced plans to integrate madrassa and duksi education into the national education system (Kihaki, 2026). Integration presupposes that a madrasa can produce reliable records of enrolment, attendance and learner progress, which most keep on paper or not at all.

The conditions for a mobile solution are present. The Communications Authority of Kenya (2023) reported 66.4 million mobile SIM subscriptions, a penetration rate of 131.3 per cent, and the Kenya National Digital Master Plan 2022–2032 makes the digitisation of services a national priority (Ministry of ICT and the Digital Economy, 2022). Consumer Quran applications already show that recitation practice can be supported on a phone, but they are built for individual learners and do not model the institution in which a teacher, a parent and a student share responsibility for a child's progress. This project therefore developed the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application, a mobile application that brings madrasa administration and Quran learning together in one secure platform.

Its branded implementation, ILMORA (Integrated Qur'an & Madrasa Learning), is the name users see in the application and in the screenshots of this report.

1.2 Problem Statement

Madrasas in Kenya lack standardised systems for recording admission, attendance, memorisation progress and fees. Records are usually kept in exercise books held by individual teachers; they are easily lost, cannot be summarised for the institution and cannot be shared with parents. Parents therefore have little reliable information about whether their child attends, how far the child has memorised, or what fees are owed. Recitation can only be assessed when a teacher hears each learner in turn, so in large classes feedback is infrequent, and fees are collected in cash or by M-Pesa with no link to an invoice or receipt.

Existing software addresses only parts of this problem. Quran applications support individual practice but have no teacher role, parental access, attendance register or fee records, while general school management systems have no Quran-specific functions such as memorisation tracking by juz or recitation review. Neither is designed for many independent madrasas, each of which must be able to trust that its records cannot be seen by another. There is therefore a need for a secure, multi-tenant mobile application that unifies madrasa administration with Quran learning.

1.3 Objectives

1.3.1 General Objective

To develop an integrated mobile application for managing madrasas in Kenya that combines student administration, attendance, Quran memorisation and recitation review, parent involvement, and fee invoicing and payment within a single role-based platform.

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

1. To analyse the administrative and learning challenges facing madrasas in Kenya.
2. To review existing education management systems and Quran applications and identify their limitations.

3. To design and develop a multi-tenant, role-based mobile application for madrasa owners, teachers, parents and students covering admission, attendance, memorisation, recitation review, live lessons, parent linking, parent–teacher messaging, fees and M-Pesa payment.
4. To test the developed system for functional correctness, data integrity and enforcement of authorisation between madrasas and roles.

1.4 Research Questions

1. What administrative and learning challenges do madrasas in Kenya face?
2. What are the limitations of existing education management systems and Quran applications for madrasas?
3. How can a multi-tenant mobile application integrate madrasa administration with Quran learning while keeping each madrasa's records private?
4. To what extent does the developed system meet its functional and security requirements when tested?

1.5 Justification

Islam encourages seeking and spreading beneficial knowledge: "Allah will raise those who have believed among you and those who were given knowledge, by degrees" (Surah Al-Mujadilah 58:11). Within that motivation the project benefits each stakeholder. Madrasa owners gain institutional records of enrolment, attendance and fees, a practical precondition for integration into the national education system (Kihaki, 2026). Teachers have class rosters, attendance, recitation review and parent requests in one place. Parents see an approved child's attendance, progress and fees; Fan and Chen (2001) found a meaningful relationship between parental involvement and academic achievement, and Epstein (2018) identifies regular school-to-home communication as a core form of involvement. Students can record a recitation for review without waiting for their turn in class.

1.6 Scope of the Project

The project covers the design, development and testing of an Android application and its cloud backend for madrasas in Kenya. It serves four roles: the madrasa owner, the teacher, the parent and the student. The implemented scope includes madrasa registration and sign-in; student

admission with system-generated admission numbers; classes and staff; manual and QR-code attendance; parent–child linking approved by the madrasa; memorisation tracking, assignments, grades and certificates; recitation recording with private audio storage, AI feedback given only with a parent's consent, and teacher review; comparison with a master reciter, recite-along practice, a daily hifz plan, hifz streaks and badges and a class mistake map; a live reading room with scheduled sessions on Google Meet or Zoom; a library of teacher-chosen Quran videos; fee invoices paid by M-Pesa or card with receipts; sponsorship of pupils; announcements, parent–teacher messaging, notifications and spoken progress reports; attendance that can be marked offline; USSD access for basic phones; an impact dashboard; a web console for the platform administrator; and an interface in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic. Curricula such as Tafsir and Fiqh, and the training of a dedicated tajweed recognition model, are outside the scope.

1.7 Limitations

M-Pesa runs on Safaricom's Daraja sandbox, which sends a real payment prompt to a Safaricom phone but moves only test money; accepting real fees needs a registered Paybill or Till number. Card payments, e-mail and SMS were exercised against mock providers that behave like the real services, because live Paystack and messaging credentials could not be obtained within the project. Video in live lessons is provided through Google Meet or Zoom links, because in-app video needs a paid provider; it is built but switched off. The installed app was tested on an Android emulator rather than a range of physical phones, and push notifications need a Firebase project to be configured before they can be delivered. The automated tajweed feedback comes from a general-purpose AI model (Google Gemini), not a validated tajweed assessor, so it is labelled provisional and the teacher's review remains the authoritative assessment. No usability study with real users has yet been carried out, and the project evaluates whether the system works as specified, not its effect on memorisation over time.

1.8 Summary

This chapter introduced the role of madrasas in Quran education in Kenya and the record-keeping, visibility and assessment problems they face as their integration into the national education system is planned. It stated the objectives and research questions of the project and set out its justification, scope and limitations. Chapter Two reviews the literature and existing systems.

CHAPTER TWO

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter reviews the literature on madrasa education and administration in Kenya, the challenges of traditional madrasa management, and existing education management systems and Quran applications. It then discusses how a mobile-based integrated system can be designed, implemented and tested to address the gaps identified.

2.2 Challenges in Traditional Madrasa Administration and Quran Learning

2.2.1 Informal Record Keeping and Lack of Standardisation

Quranic schools are among the oldest continuously operating educational institutions in the Muslim world. Boyle (2004) describes their core pedagogy as the memorisation and correct recitation of the Quran under the close supervision of a teacher. In Kenya this tradition is carried by the duksi, which concentrate on recitation and memorisation, and by madrasas, which add Arabic, Fiqh and Islamic history. Most are founded and run by communities, mosques or individual teachers rather than by the state.

Aden (2017) notes that Islamic and secular education in Kenya have largely developed in parallel, with learners attending the madrasa before or after the public school day. Ndzovu (2023) highlights the absence of a standardised syllabus as a persistent issue, and the same lack of standardisation extends to records. An owner or head teacher admits learners, allocates them to classes and collects fees, while each teacher keeps his or her own notebook of attendance and of how far each learner has memorised. Such records are easily lost, give the institution no single view of a learner, and cannot identify a child who moves between classes or madrasas. With madrasas now to be integrated into the national education system (Kihaki, 2026), reliable records have become a necessity. The community Madrasa preschool programme, evaluated by Mwaura et al. (2008), shows that madrasa-linked education can be organised and assessed when it is structured.

2.2.2 Limited Parental Visibility and Assessment Workload

Parents usually learn about attendance and progress informally, at pick-up or only when a problem has become serious. Fan and Chen (2001), in a meta-analysis, found a small to moderate but practically meaningful relationship between parental involvement and academic achievement, and Emerson et al. (2012) conclude that engagement is most effective when it is focused on the child's own learning. Epstein (2018) identifies regular school-to-home communication as one of the core types of family involvement. A madrasa that cannot tell parents how their child is doing loses this support.

Recitation must be heard to be assessed, so a teacher's capacity to give individual tajweed feedback is limited by class size and time. In large classes learners may recite to the teacher only occasionally, and persistent errors can go uncorrected between sessions.

2.2.3 Financial, Logistical and Communication Barriers

Madrasa fees are typically recorded by hand and reminded verbally. Payments made in cash or by M-Pesa are not linked to an invoice, which makes balances hard to reconcile and disputes hard to resolve. Communication between the madrasa and families relies on phone calls and word of mouth, and parents who speak Kiswahili, Somali or Arabic rather than English may be excluded from written notices. At the same time Kenya is highly connected: the Communications Authority of Kenya (2023) reported a mobile penetration of 131.3 per cent, and the Kenya National Digital Master Plan 2022–2032 commits the government to the digitisation of services (Ministry of ICT and the Digital Economy, 2022). The phone that parents already use for M-Pesa is therefore a practical channel for records, payments and notices.

2.3 Review of Existing Madrasa Management and Quran Learning Applications

2.3.1 Overview of Existing Education Management and Quran Applications

National Education Management Information System (NEMIS). The Ministry of Education operates NEMIS, which links each learner to a unique identifier and reports national indicators for registered institutions (Ministry of Education, n.d.); a replacement, the Kenya Education Management Information System, was announced in 2025 (Tongola, 2025). It serves national reporting rather than the day-to-day running of a madrasa.

Learning management systems. Moodle and Google Classroom provide courses, assignments, grading and messaging. Moodle was designed around social-constructivist learning communities (Dougiamas & Taylor, 2003).

School administration software. Commercial products used in Kenyan schools focus on fee collection, examinations and communication for primary and secondary schools following the national curriculum.

Quran applications. Tarteel listens to a user's recitation, follows along in the text and flags memorisation mistakes such as skipped words (Tarteel AI, n.d.). Quran.com and similar readers provide the text, translations and audio by recognised reciters (Quran.com, n.d.). Masalha and Hirzallah (2014) proposed a student attendance system in which learners scan a QR code to register their presence.

2.3.2 Usability, Accessibility and Functional Limitations

Al-Fraihat et al. (2020) found that system, information and support quality together explain much of learners' satisfaction with e-learning systems, and Coates, James and Baldwin (2005) caution that learning management systems tend to impose a generic model of teaching. None of the management systems reviewed tracks memorisation by juz, handles recitation audio or links a parent to a child through an approval process, and most are available only in English. Quran applications, in turn, are individual tools with no teacher, parent or institutional role and no attendance or fee records.

Automated recitation assessment also has clear limits. Al-Ayyoub, Damer and Hmeidi (2018) reported over 97 per cent accuracy in classifying eight recitation rules on an in-house dataset, but Al-Kharusi et al. (2025) argue that the field relies on small and demographically biased datasets, and Alsharhan and Ramsay (2020) show that speaker gender, dialect and training size materially affect Arabic speech recognition. Automated tajweed feedback can therefore support, but not replace, the teacher. A static attendance QR code can be photographed and shared, so it proves presence only if it changes and is verified by the server.

2.3.3 Identified Gaps from Reviewed Systems

The review identified the following gaps:

- No reviewed system combines madrasa administration with Quran learning.
- Parents have no structured, child-specific view of attendance, progress and fees.
- Fee payments are not linked to invoices and receipts.
- Automated tajweed assessment is not reliable enough to be authoritative.
- Shared platforms must keep each institution's records separate.
- Interfaces are rarely available in the languages of Kenyan madrasa communities.

2.4 Development of a Mobile-Based Integrated Madrasa Management System

2.4.1 System Design and Architecture Overview

Where many independent organisations share one application, the application is multi-tenant. Bezemer and Zaidman (2010) observe that multi-tenancy reduces operating cost but makes isolation between tenants a central engineering concern, and Alkhalil, Sahandi and John (2017) found that perceived security shapes the decision to move records into the cloud. Within each tenant, role-based access control assigns permissions to roles rather than individuals (Sandhu et al., 2000), which matches the owner, teacher, parent and student roles of a madrasa. The proposed system is therefore a single mobile application backed by a managed cloud database, in which each madrasa is a separate tenant and every user acts in one role.

2.4.2 Implementation Using React Native (Expo) and Supabase

Cross-platform frameworks allow one codebase to serve several mobile platforms (Biørn-Hansen et al., 2018). The system uses React Native with the Expo toolchain and TypeScript for the application, and Supabase for the backend: a PostgreSQL database, authentication, file storage for recitation audio, and server functions for privileged operations such as payments. PostgreSQL Row Level Security lets the database itself decide which rows each user may read or change (PostgreSQL Global Development Group, n.d.), so one madrasa's records stay private even if the application code contains an error.

2.4.3 Integration of Administration and Quran Learning Modules

The administration module covers admission, classes, staff, attendance, fees and communication; the learning module covers memorisation, assignments, grades, certificates and recitation review.

They share one student record, so attendance, memorisation and fees appear together on the teacher's and the parent's screens. Holmes, Bialik and Fadel (2019) argue that artificial intelligence in education should augment rather than replace the teacher. VanLehn (2011) found that intelligent tutoring approached the effectiveness of human tutoring, and Neri, Cucchiarini and Strik (2008) showed that automatic pronunciation feedback improved learners' speech. The system accordingly labels any automated recitation feedback as provisional and makes the teacher's review final.

2.4.4 Expected Benefits to Kenyan Madrasas

The integrated system is expected to give madrasas reliable records of enrolment, attendance and progress; give approved parents timely information about their children; reduce teachers' clerical work; link fee payments to invoices and receipts through M-Pesa; and reach families in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic.

2.5 Testing of the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application

2.5.1 Functionality and Performance Testing

Sommerville (2016) distinguishes development testing of components, release testing against requirements, and user testing. For a multi-tenant system the most important functional tests are those that prove a user cannot reach another madrasa's records or act outside their role; these must test refusals as well as successes. Performance testing checks that screens load quickly over mobile networks.

2.5.2 Usability and User Experience Evaluation

Usability can be measured with the System Usability Scale, a ten-item questionnaire that yields a score from 0 to 100 (Brooke, 1996). It suits users with limited experience of mobile applications and can be administered in the local language.

2.5.3 Reliability and Field Testing Approach

Reliability depends on the system behaving correctly with real data and devices. Testing against the deployed backend with test accounts for every role, followed by field testing in a pilot madrasa

on the phones its teachers and parents already own, gives confidence that the system will work outside the development environment.

2.6 Summary

This chapter reviewed madrasa education and administration in Kenya and the challenges of informal records, limited parental visibility, assessment workload and fee management. Existing education management systems and Quran applications each address only part of the problem, and none combines madrasa administration with Quran learning under strict separation of institutions. The chapter outlined how a multi-tenant mobile system built with React Native and Supabase can close this gap and how it should be tested. Chapter Three describes the development methodology.

CHAPTER THREE

3. SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the methodology adopted in developing Digital Madrasa. It describes the software development approach and the phases followed in building a working system that addresses the challenges faced by madrasas in Kenya. Because the system serves four different roles and combines administration with Quran learning, a flexible and iterative approach was needed to accommodate refinement at every stage. For this reason the Agile software development methodology was adopted.

3.2 Methodological Approach

Agile emphasises working software, collaboration and responding to change over following a fixed plan (Beck et al., 2001). It delivers a usable version of the software early and improves it in short cycles called sprints, each ending with a working increment that can be reviewed (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020). Unlike the Waterfall model, in which each phase is completed before the next begins, Agile allows requirements to be refined as the system takes shape (Sommerville, 2016).

Agile suits this project because madrasa practices vary and many requirements, such as how parents should be linked to children or how fees should be targeted, became clear only when a working version could be tried. Each sprint delivered one complete capability, from the database rules to the screens, and was verified against the live backend before the next began.

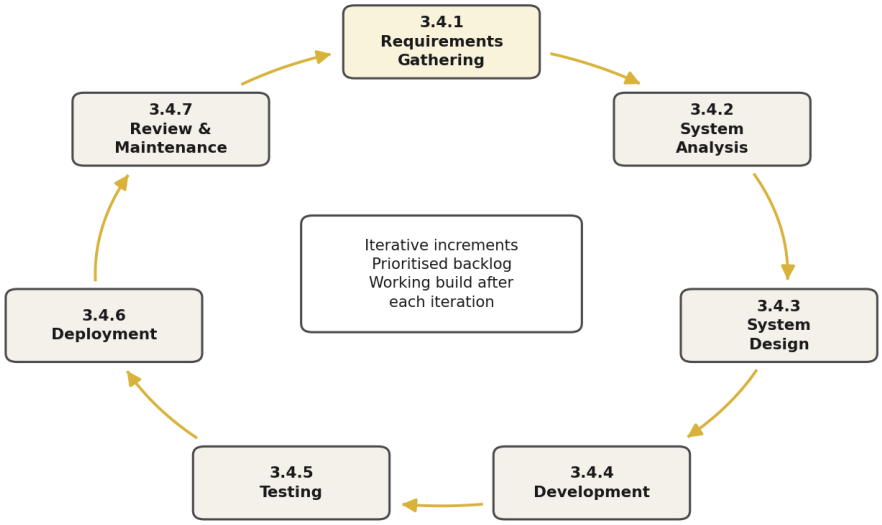


Figure 3.1 Agile Methodology

3.3 Agile Development Phases

The development of Digital Madrasa followed six Agile phases: requirements, design, development, testing, deployment and review. Each phase contributed incrementally to the project's objectives.

3.3.1 Requirements Phase

Requirements were identified from the literature on madrasa education and parental involvement, from a review of existing education management systems and Quran applications, and from the questionnaire and interview instruments prepared for madrasa stakeholders (Appendix A.1). They were organised into two modules:

- Administration module: madrasa registration, student admission, classes, staff, attendance, fees and payments, announcements and messages.
- Quran learning module: memorisation progress, assignments, grades, recitation recording and review, and certificates.

3.3.2 Design Phase

The design phase translated the requirements into the models presented in Chapter Five: the class diagram, the entity relationship diagram and database schema, use case, sequence and activity diagrams, and wireframes of the main screens. The architecture was built around React Native with Expo for the mobile interface and Supabase for authentication, the PostgreSQL database, file storage and server functions. Security rules were designed into the database from the start, so that each madrasa's records are isolated by Row Level Security.

3.3.3 Development Phase

Development proceeded in sprints recorded in the project's Git history. The first sprint (23 August 2026) produced the multi-tenant database, authentication and the screens for all four roles. The second (16 September) added the server functions, automated backups and continuous integration. Later sprints connected the live backend and the recitation storage workflow (19 September), teacher recitation review and parent access to a child's recitations (22–23 September), QR attendance (23 September) and targeted invoicing (24 September). The sprint of 25–30 September added written work and certificates, M-Pesa payments, push, e-mail and SMS notifications, and complete Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic translations. The final sprint (30 September – 2 October) connected Google Gemini for recitation feedback and a hosted AI assistant, added parental consent for AI feedback, card payments through Paystack, and fixes found by testing the installed app.

3.3.4 Testing Phase

Testing was carried out after each sprint to verify that new features worked and did not break existing ones. The testing types included:

- Unit testing: verifying individual functions such as input validation, QR token signing and M-Pesa callback handling.
- Functional testing: scripted calls to the deployed backend as each role, checking that permitted actions succeed and forbidden ones are refused.
- User interface testing: checking each screen on an Android emulator and in the web build at phone size.
- Performance testing: measuring response times of the main screens and database queries.

3.3.5 Deployment Phase

The database, storage and server functions were deployed to a hosted Supabase project from the first sprint, so every increment was tested against the real backend. During development the mobile application ran through Expo Go; at the end, Expo Application Services built an installable Android package (APK), which was installed and tested on an Android emulator.

3.3.6 Review Phase

At the end of each sprint the working increment was reviewed against the requirements, and defects found in testing were fixed before new work began. Reviews led, for example, to the rotating QR code for attendance, to requiring the madrasa's approval before a parent can see a child, and to a faster form of the database access rules after performance testing.

3.4 Summary

The Agile methodology was adopted because it allows flexibility, continuous review and delivery of working software in short cycles. Through its six phases of requirements, design, development, testing, deployment and review, the project was developed iteratively, with each sprint delivering and verifying one complete capability of the system.

CHAPTER FOUR

4. REQUIREMENTS GATHERING AND ANALYSIS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter outlines the process of requirements gathering and analysis for Digital Madrasa. The objective of this phase was to identify the needs of the system's users, namely madrasa owners and teachers, parents and students, in order to develop a practical and user-centred mobile solution. Requirements were gathered through questionnaires, interviews, observation and a review of the literature and existing systems. The process focused on how madrasas currently record attendance, memorisation and fees, how parents follow their children's progress, and how recitation is assessed. The insights obtained informed the system's architecture, database structure and role-based functions.

4.2 Data Collection Approach

A mixed approach was adopted. Structured questionnaires give comparable answers that can be counted and presented as charts, while interviews and observation explain how and why practices differ between madrasas. Combining the two ensures that the requirements are based both on how common a problem is and on the real experience of the people who face it.

4.3 Data Collection Methods

Both primary and secondary data collection methods were used. Primary data were collected directly from madrasa owners, teachers, parents and students using the questionnaire and interview guide in Appendix A.1, and by observing how attendance is taken and recitation is assessed in madrasa sessions. Secondary data were collected from published studies, government reports and a review of existing systems, as presented in Chapter Two.

The main techniques used were:

- Questionnaires for madrasa owners and teachers, parents and students
- Interviews with madrasa owners and senior teachers
- Observation of attendance taking and recitation assessment

- Review of relevant studies, reports and similar systems

4.4 Primary Data Collection

Primary data collection focused on obtaining direct insights from the people who run and use madrasas. A total of [INSERT] participants were involved in the study, comprising:

Stakeholder	Number of Respondents
Madrasa owners and teachers	[INSERT]
Parents	[INSERT]
Students	[INSERT]
Total	[INSERT]

Table 4.1 Primary Data Collection

4.5 Data Analysis

Questionnaire responses were summarised as counts and presented as pie charts, while interview and observation notes were analysed for recurring themes, challenges and expectations. Each finding was then mapped to a feature of the system.

4.5.1 Interview Data Summary

The following tables summarise the interview responses from each stakeholder group.

Madrasa Owner and Teacher Interview Summary

Theme	Key Insights from Madrasa Owner and Teachers
Record keeping	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Attendance	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Memorisation tracking	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Fee collection	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Communication with parents	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Expectations	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]

Table 4.2 Madrasa Owner and Teacher Interview Summary

Parent Interview Summary

Theme	Key Insights from Parents
Knowledge of attendance	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Knowledge of progress	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Fee payment	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Communication with the madrasa	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Expectations	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]

Table 4.3 Parent Interview Summary

Student Interview Summary

Theme	Key Insights from Students
Recitation practice	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Feedback from the teacher	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Use of phones	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]
Expectations	[INSERT ACTUAL FINDINGS HERE]

Table 4.4 Student Interview Summary

4.5.2 Questionnaire Analysis

Madrasa Owner and Teacher Questionnaire Analysis

A total of [INSERT] madrasa owners and teachers participated in the survey. The objective was to understand how attendance, memorisation progress and fees are currently managed.

Question 1: How is student attendance currently recorded in your madrasa?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: “How is student attendance currently recorded in your madrasa?”

Figure 4.1 Recording Student Attendance

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

The system provides a digital attendance register for each class and QR-code attendance, in which a student scans a code on the teacher’s phone that changes every 30 seconds, so attendance is recorded once, cannot be forged and is summarised on the dashboard.

Question 2: How is a student’s Quran memorisation progress recorded?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: “How is a student’s Quran memorisation progress recorded?”

Figure 4.2 Memorisation Progress Tracking

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

Teachers record memorisation surah by surah in the app. The system calculates the juz completed and the passages due for revision, and shows them to the student and the approved parent.

Question 3: How are fees recorded and communicated to parents?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: "How are fees recorded and communicated to parents?"

Figure 4.3 Fee Collection Methods

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

The owner defines fee structures and issues numbered invoices to the whole madrasa, a class or one student. Parents see each invoice and pay it by M-Pesa, and the system issues a receipt and updates the balance automatically.

Parent Questionnaire Analysis

A total of [INSERT] parents participated in the survey. The questionnaire focused on how parents follow their children's madrasa education and pay fees.

Question 1: How do you currently learn about your child's attendance and progress?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: "How do you currently learn about your child's attendance and progress?"

Figure 4.4 Parent Access to Child Progress

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

A parent links to a child using the admission number and date of birth; once the madrasa approves the link, the parent sees the child's attendance, memorisation, grades, recitations and fees, and receives notifications.

Question 2: Would you pay madrasa fees through M-Pesa in a mobile application?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: "Would you pay madrasa fees through M-Pesa in a mobile application?"

Figure 4.5 Willingness to Pay Fees via M-Pesa

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

The parent pays one or several invoices through an M-Pesa prompt on their phone. The amount is calculated by the server, and the receipt appears in the app as soon as payment is confirmed.

Student Questionnaire Analysis

A total of [INSERT] students participated in the survey, with the consent of their parents. The purpose was to understand how recitation is practised and assessed.

Question 1: How does your teacher assess your recitation?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: “How does your teacher assess your recitation?”

Figure 4.6 Recitation Assessment Methods

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

Students record a recitation in the app. The recording is stored privately, the teacher listens and gives a score and comments, and the student and approved parent see the review.

Question 2: Would recording your recitation on a phone help you practise?

[INSERT PIE CHART HERE]

Pie chart of responses to: “Would recording your recitation on a phone help you practise?”

Figure 4.7 Digital Recitation Practice

Chart to be inserted from the questionnaire results.

Analysis

[INSERT ACTUAL SURVEY RESULTS HERE]

System Solution

The app lets students record as often as they need, shows the passages due for revision, and provides the Quran text for reading offline.

4.6 Secondary Data Collection

Secondary data provided background that complemented the primary data. A review of academic literature, government reports and existing systems (Chapter Two) showed that madrasa records in Kenya are largely informal and unstandardised (Ndzovu, 2023), that the government plans to integrate madrasa education into the national system (Kihaki, 2026), and that parental involvement is associated with better achievement (Fan & Chen, 2001). It also showed that Kenya’s mobile penetration makes a phone-based system practical (Communications Authority of Kenya, 2023) and that automated tajweed assessment is not yet reliable enough to replace the teacher (Al-Kharusi et al., 2025). These findings reinforced the need for an integrated system that combines madrasa administration, Quran learning, parental access and fee management.

4.7 Requirements and Stakeholders Identification

Based on the analysed data, the requirements were categorised as follows.

Functional Requirements

The system shall allow a madrasa owner to register the madrasa, admit students with automatically generated admission numbers, create classes, add teachers, define fee structures and issue invoices. Teachers shall take attendance manually or by QR code, record memorisation, set and mark assignments, grade students, review recitations and award certificates. Parents shall request a link to their child, view the approved child's attendance, progress and invoices, pay fees by M-Pesa and message the madrasa. Students shall scan attendance codes, record recitations, hand in work and view their own progress. The system shall send notifications for announcements, invoices, payments and reviews, and provide role-based dashboards.

Non-Functional Requirements

The system shall keep each madrasa's records private from every other madrasa and allow each user only the actions of their role. It shall respond quickly on mobile networks, protect passwords and data in transit, and store recitation audio privately. It shall be easy to use for people with limited experience of mobile applications and be available in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic. Payments shall be settled exactly once for the amount the server calculates, and important actions shall be recorded in an audit log.

Stakeholders Identification

Madrasa owners register the madrasa, manage students, staff and fees, and oversee operations. Teachers take attendance, track memorisation, review recitations and communicate with parents. Parents follow their children's progress and pay fees. Students record recitations, scan attendance and follow their own progress. A platform administrator oversees the madrasas using the service. Government education authorities influence the system indirectly through the plans to integrate madrasa education into the national system.

4.8 Challenges in Requirements Gathering and Analysis

Several challenges influenced the requirements gathering process.

Diverse stakeholder needs: owners prioritise records and fees, teachers prioritise simple attendance and review, and parents want timely information. Features were prioritised by how many roles they serve and how directly they address the problem statement.

Limited stakeholder availability: madrasa sessions run early in the morning, in the evening and at weekends, which limited the time available for interviews and observation.

Sensitivity of children's data: information about minors requires consent and care. Questions were framed neutrally, students took part only with parental consent, and the system was designed so that a parent sees a child only after the madrasa approves the link.

Technical constraints: features such as a validated tajweed recognition model and live M-Pesa credentials were beyond the project's resources, so the system was designed to accept them later without redesign.

Variations in madrasa practice: madrasas differ in class levels, fee structures and languages, so the system lets each madrasa define its own classes and fees and offers four languages.

4.9 Summary

This chapter described how the requirements of Digital Madrasa were gathered and analysed from madrasa owners and teachers, parents, students and the literature. The system must provide secure sign-in, digital attendance, memorisation tracking, recitation review, parent access approved by the madrasa, fee invoicing with M-Pesa payment, notifications and role-based dashboards, while keeping each madrasa's data private. These requirements form the foundation of the design presented in Chapter Five.

CHAPTER FIVE

5. SYSTEM DESIGN

5.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the design of Digital Madrasa. From the structure of the data and the database schema to the interactions between users and the system and the layout of the user interfaces, each part of the design was planned to meet the requirements identified in Chapter Four. Particular attention was given to role-based access for owners, teachers, parents and students, and to keeping each madrasa's records separate from every other madrasa.

5.2 Structural Diagram

Structural diagrams describe the static architecture of the system by showing its components, such as classes and their relationships (Sommerville, 2016). They provide a blueprint of how data and objects are organised and help developers understand how the parts of the system fit together.

5.2.1 Class Diagram

The class diagram in Figure 5.1 shows the main classes of the system, their attributes and operations, and the relationships between them. A Madrasa has many students, teachers, classes, fee structures and announcements. A Student belongs to one madrasa and has attendance records, memorisation progress, recitations and invoices, and a Parent is connected to a Student through a ParentStudentLink that the madrasa approves. Each Recitation may receive TajweedFeedback, which the teacher reviews.

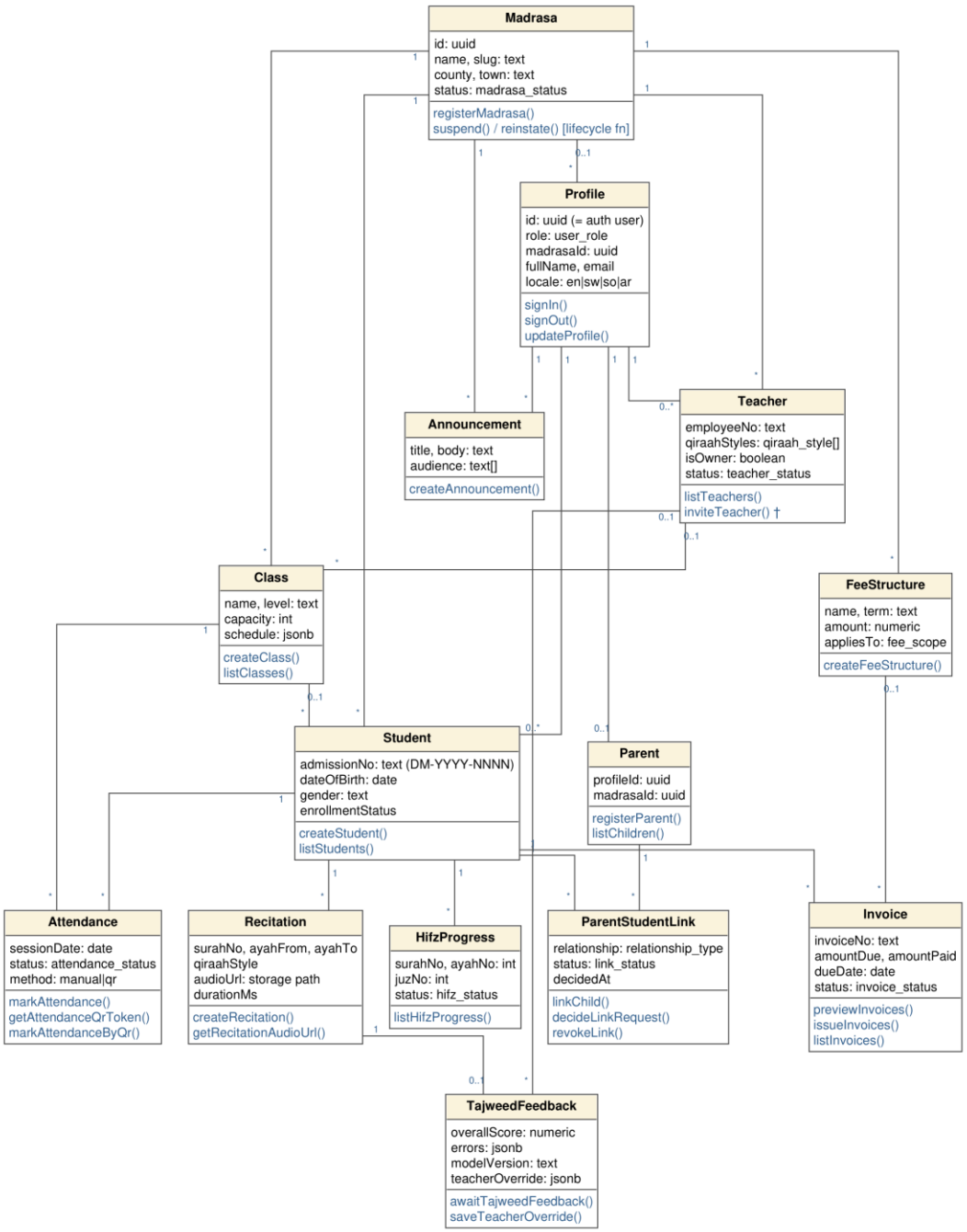


Figure 5.1 Class Diagram

5.2.2 Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD)

The Entity Relationship Diagram in Figure 5.2 represents the core data of the system: the entities, their key attributes and the relationships between them, with cardinalities (1 and N). It was

generated from the live database, so it matches the implemented schema. Every record carries the identifier of its madrasa, which is how the database keeps each madrasa's data separate.

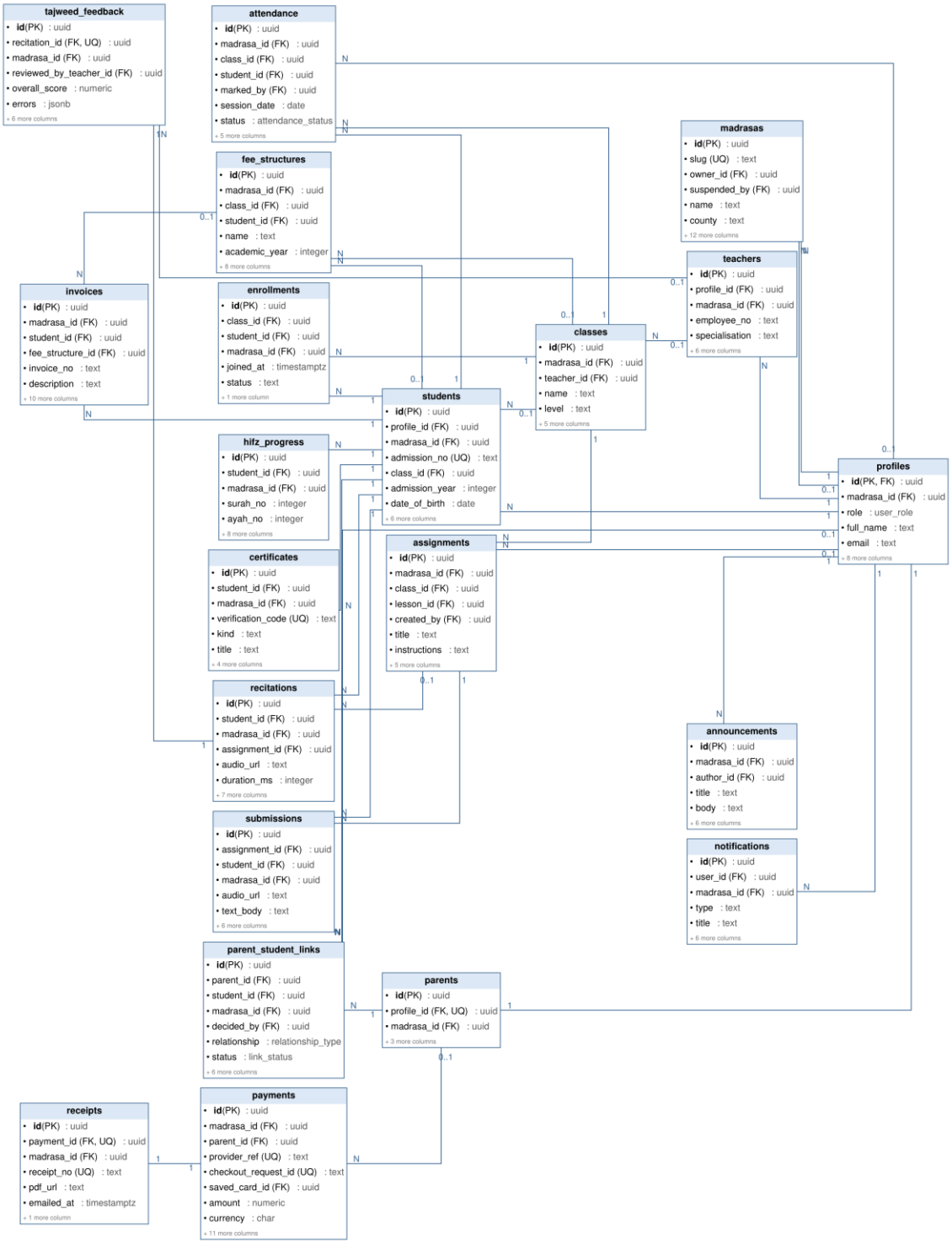


Figure 5.2 ERD Diagram

5.3 Behavioral Diagrams

Behavioural diagrams illustrate how the system responds to user actions and internal events. They show the flow of activities, the order of operations and how each actor interacts with the system, and guide implementation decisions.

5.3.1 Use Case Diagram

The system has four main users: the madrasa owner, the teacher, the parent and the student, with a platform administrator who oversees the madrasas. The owner registers the madrasa, admits students, manages classes and staff, and defines fees and issues invoices; because an owner is also a teacher, the owner can do everything a teacher does. Teachers take attendance, display the rotating QR code, record grades and assignments, review recitations and decide parent link requests. Students scan the class QR code, record recitations and view their progress. Parents create an account, request a link to their child, view the child's progress and invoices and message the madrasa. Figure 5.3 shows these interactions.

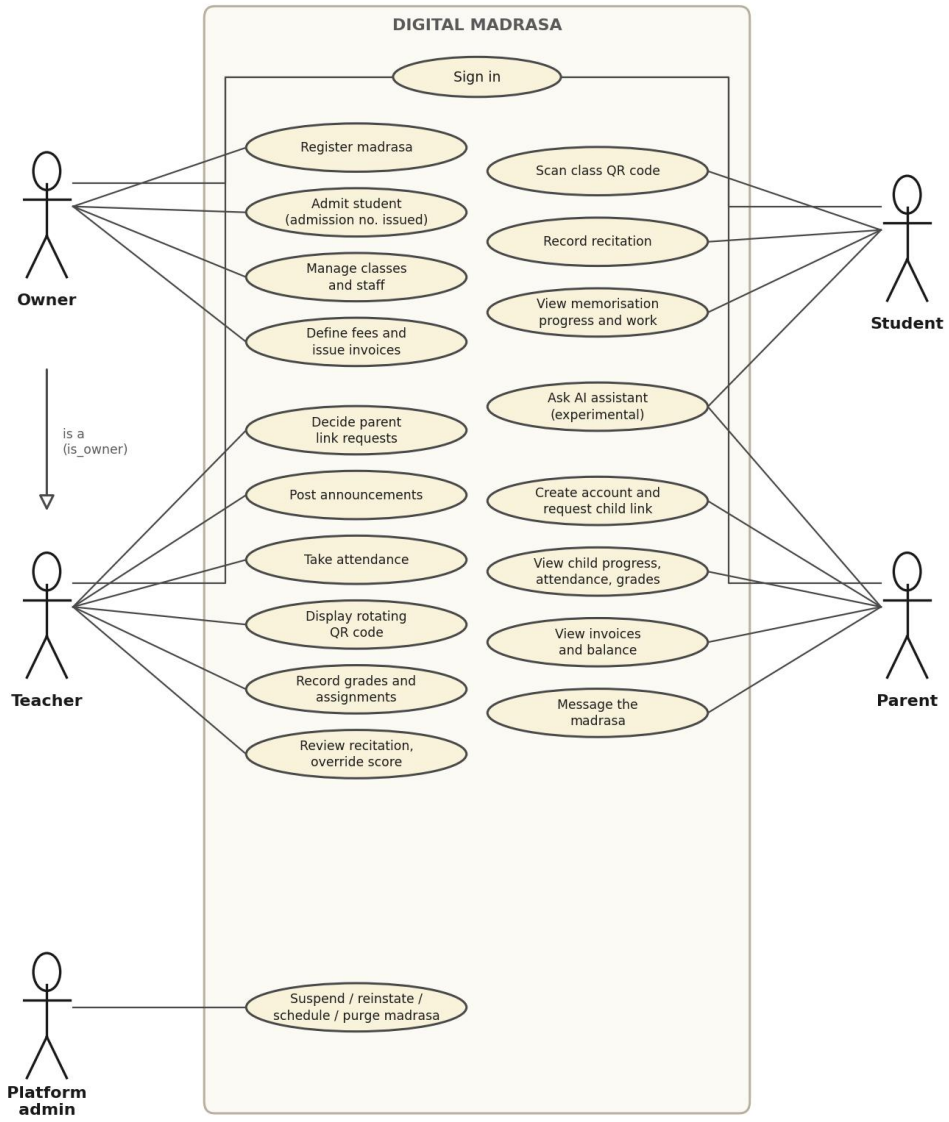


Figure 5.3 Use Case Diagram

5.3.2 Sequence Diagram

Sequence diagrams show the interactions between objects over time. Figure 5.4 shows recitation submission and review. The student's app requests a private upload link, uploads the audio to storage and asks the server to evaluate it; the server stores the recitation and a provisional result. The teacher then opens the review queue, plays the recording through a short-lived link and saves a score, which the student and the approved parent can see.

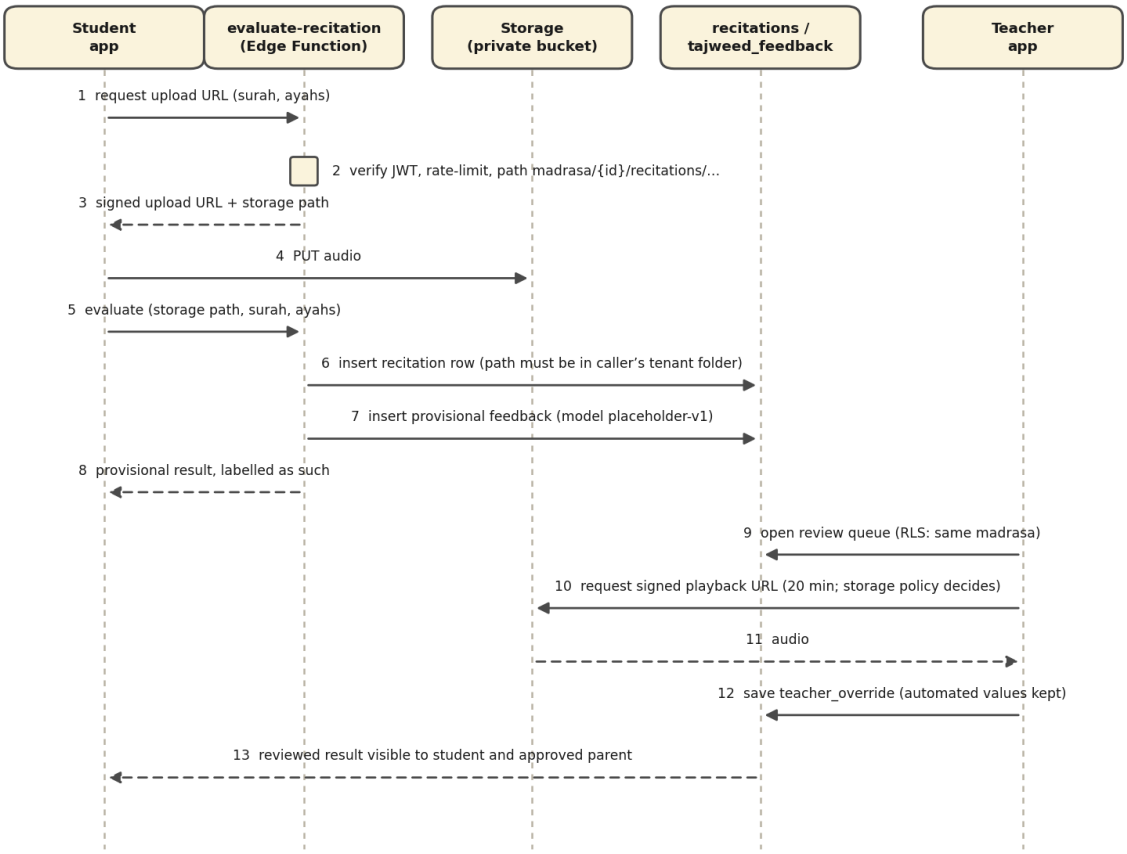


Figure 5.4 Sequence Diagram

5.3.3 Activity Diagram

The activity diagram in Figure 5.5 shows QR attendance. The teacher opens the class attendance screen and the system displays a signed code that changes every 30 seconds. A student scans the code, and the server checks the signature, the time window, the class and the student's role before recording the student as present; an expired or wrong code is refused.

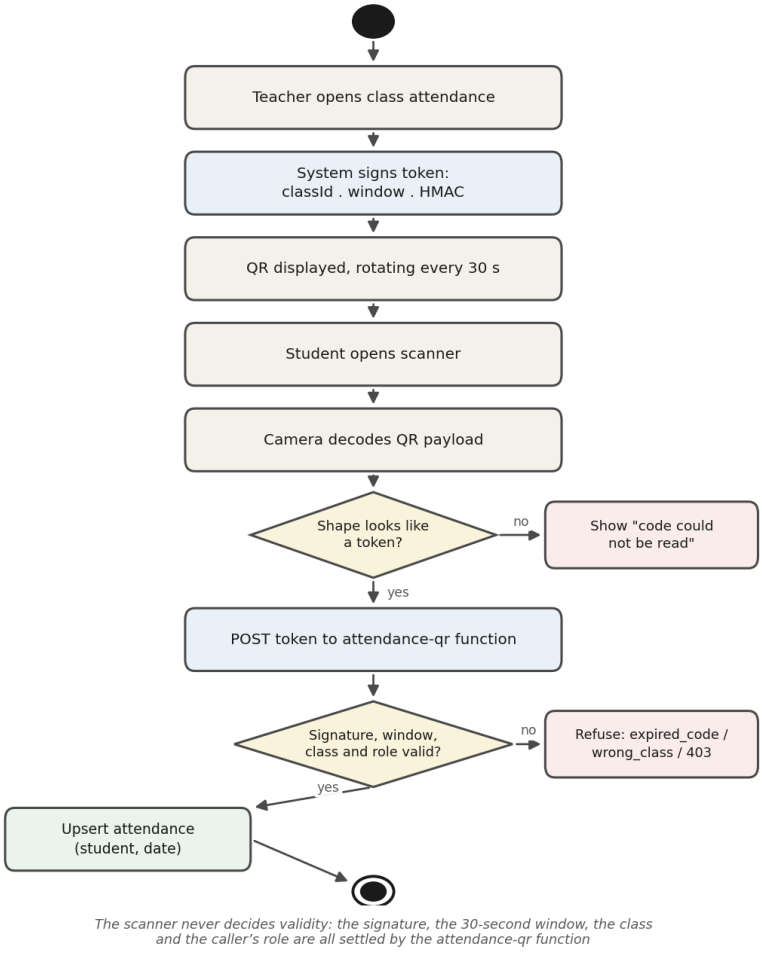


Figure 5.5 Activity Diagram

5.4 Database Schema

The database schema defines how data is organised and stored. Digital Madrasa uses a PostgreSQL database of 42 tables grouped into functional areas: tenancy and identity, access control, learning, attendance, recitation, finance, subscription, communication and operations, as shown in Figure 5.6. Every table that belongs to a madrasa carries its madrasa identifier, and Row Level Security is enabled on all 42 tables so that users can read and change only the records their role allows.

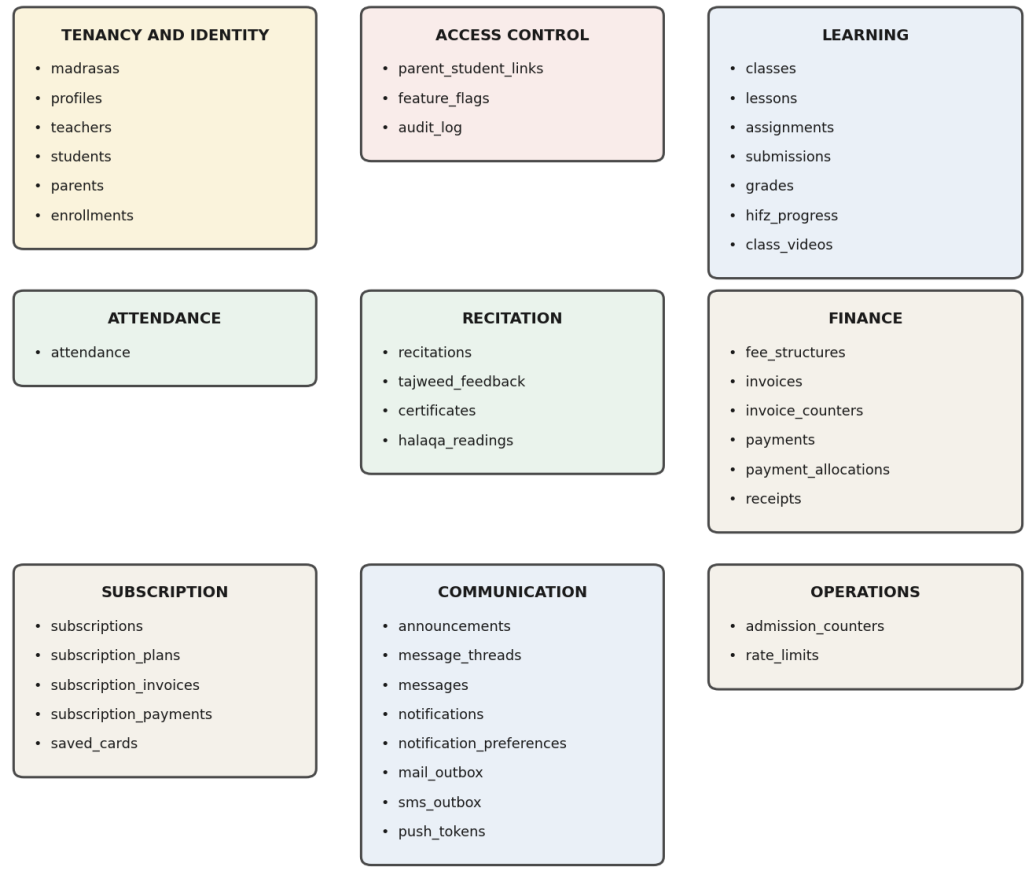


Figure 5.6 Database Schema

5.5 Wireframes

The wireframes in Figure 5.7 illustrate the core user interfaces of the application: the sign-in screen, the teacher dashboard with attendance and fee summaries, QR attendance scanning, and the review screen shown before invoices are issued. They set out the main navigation and the flow of interaction that the implemented screens follow.

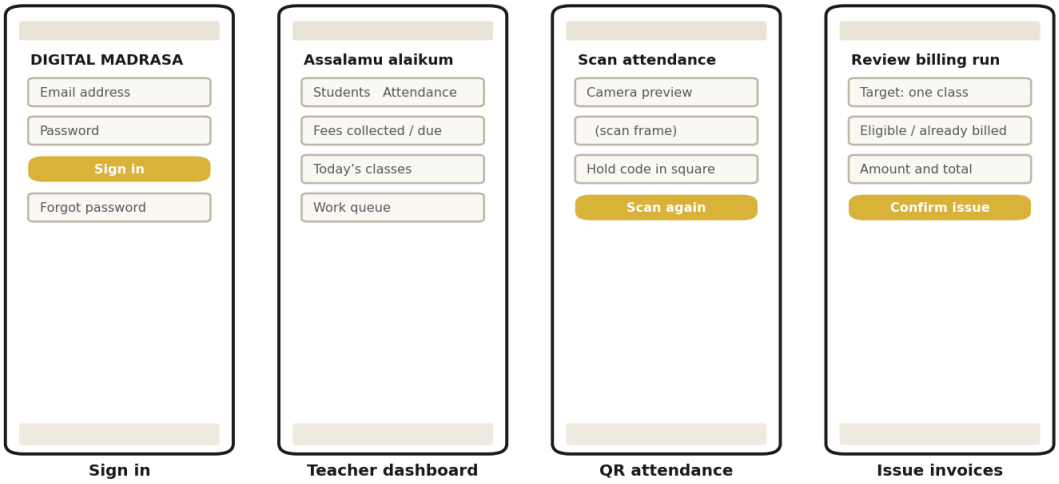


Figure 5.7 Wireframes

5.6 Summary

This chapter presented the design of Digital Madrasa. The class diagram and ERD define the main entities and their relationships, the use case diagram shows what each user can do, the sequence and activity diagrams describe recitation review and QR attendance, the database schema organises the 42 tables, and the wireframes give a visual overview of the interface. Together these form the blueprint for the development described in Chapter Six.

CHAPTER SIX

6. SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT

6.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the development of the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application, implemented under the brand ILMORA. It outlines the tools, technologies and techniques used, describes the interfaces through which each user interacts with the system, and discusses the challenges encountered during development and how they were addressed. The aim is to show how the designs of Chapter Five were turned into a working mobile application.

6.2 System Development Tools and Techniques

The system was built with tools chosen for cross-platform mobile development, secure data management and low cost. The front end is a single React Native codebase and the back end is a hosted Supabase project, so the same application serves every role while the database enforces what each role may see and do.

6.2.1 Integrated Development Environment (IDE)

Visual Studio Code was used as the main integrated development environment. It provides TypeScript language support that reports errors as code is written, an integrated terminal for running the Expo development server and the test scripts, and Git integration for version control. The Android emulator from Android Studio was used to run the application during development, and the web build was used to check screens at phone size.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT HERE]

VS Code with the Digital Madrasa project open (explorer showing apps, packages and supabase)

Figure 6.1 Visual Studio Code

Screenshot to be inserted by the developer.

6.2.2 Front-end Development

The front end was developed with React Native and the Expo toolchain (SDK 54) in TypeScript, which lets one codebase run on Android devices and in a web browser. Expo Router organises the screens into separate groups for the owner, teacher, parent and student, so each user sees a dashboard tailored to their role. TanStack Query keeps data from the server up to date, and i18next provides the interface in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic. The front end includes sign-up and sign-in screens, dashboards, student admission and class management, attendance with a QR scanner that also works offline, recitation recording and practice, the live reading room, the video library, fee and payment screens with receipts, and announcements, messages and notifications.

6.2.3 Database Management Tools

Supabase was used to manage the data collected by the app. It provides a PostgreSQL database, user authentication, private file storage for recitation audio, and Edge Functions that run privileged operations, such as issuing invoices, starting M-Pesa payments and delivering notifications, on the server. The database schema was created through 41 version-controlled migrations, and Row Level Security policies on every table keep each madrasa's records private. Supabase Realtime carries the live reading room on private channels that only the class may join. Outside services are called only from the server functions: Google Gemini, which listens to a recitation (when a parent has

given consent), answers the AI assistant's questions and speaks progress reports; Safaricom Daraja, which sends the M-Pesa payment prompt to the parent's phone; and Paystack, whose hosted page takes card payments so that card numbers never pass through the app. Quran videos are played through YouTube's embedded player from links the teacher chooses, so no YouTube API key is needed.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT HERE]

Supabase dashboard showing the project's tables (Table Editor) or Edge Functions

Figure 6.2 Supabase Setup

Screenshot to be inserted by the developer.

6.3 System Interfaces

ILMORA, the branded implementation of the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application, provides interfaces tailored to each user role. All screens follow the same layout, with a bottom navigation bar, clear headings and summary cards, so that users with different levels of experience can move through the application easily. The following screenshots, captured on an Android phone screen, show the interfaces that users interact with.

Sign Up Interface

A new user chooses to register a madrasa or to create a parent account. Figure 6.3 shows the parent sign-up form, which collects the parent's name, e-mail address, phone number and password, and asks for consent under the Kenya Data Protection Act 2019.

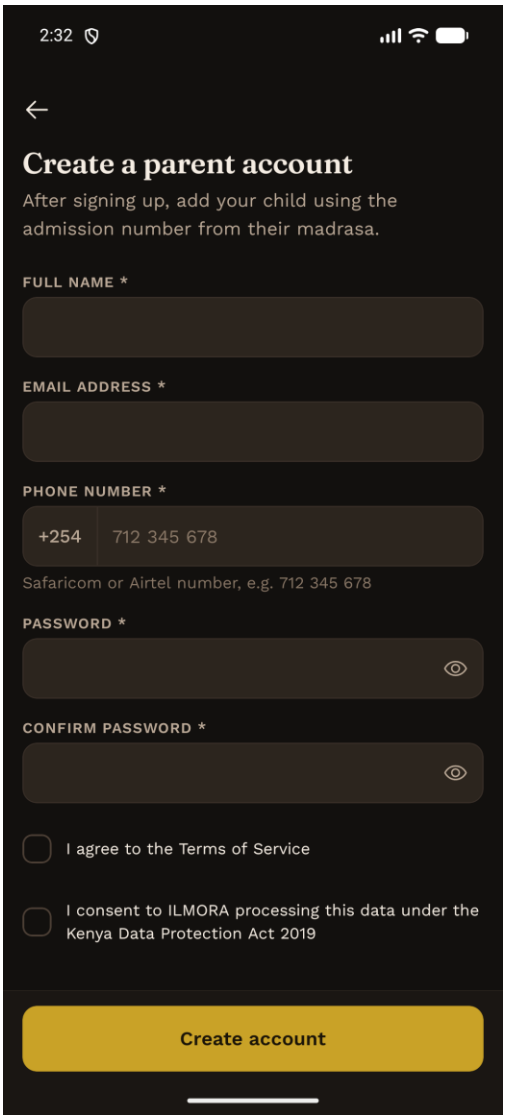


Figure 6.3 App Interface Sign Up

Owner Interface

The owner's dashboard (Figure 6.4) shows the number of students, attendance for the week, fees collected and outstanding, pending parent link requests and today's classes, with tabs for students, classes, fees and more.

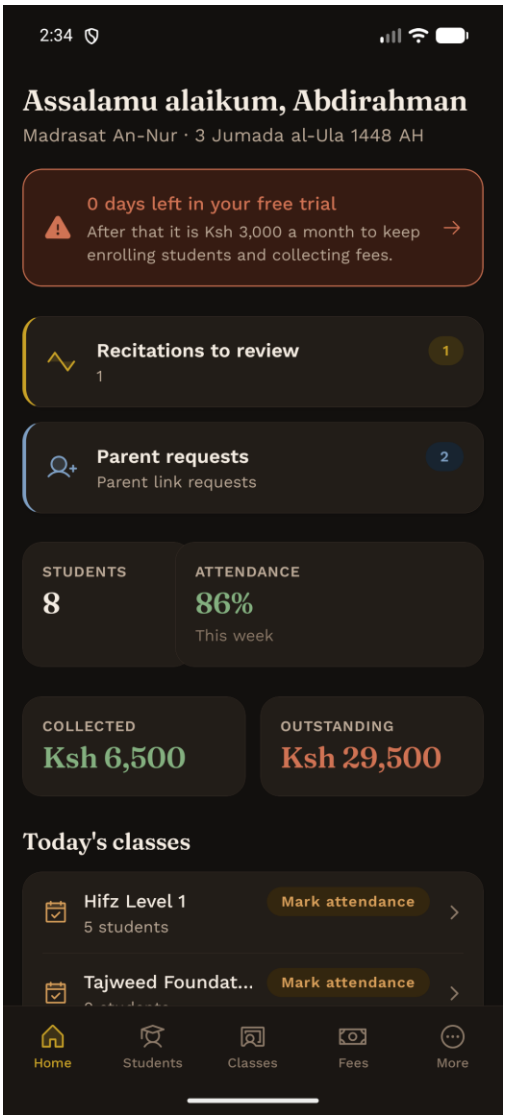


Figure 6.4 Owner Dashboard

Teacher Interface

The teacher's dashboard (Figure 6.5) lists the teacher's classes with a shortcut to mark attendance, together with parent requests and summary figures for the madrasa.

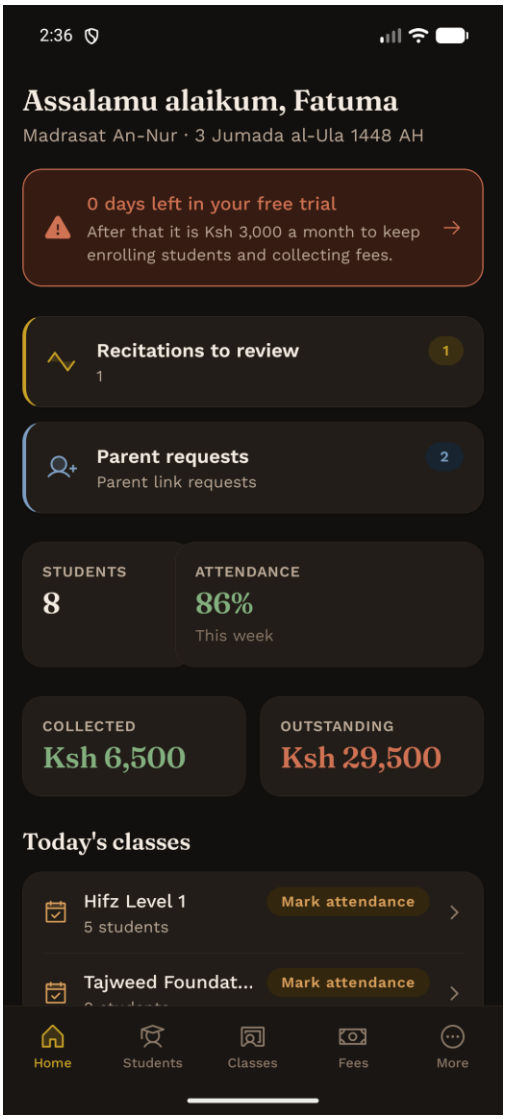


Figure 6.5 Teacher Dashboard

Parent Interface

The parent's dashboard (Figure 6.6) lets a parent switch between approved children and see each child's admission number, memorisation, attendance rate, outstanding balance and recent attendance, with tabs for fees, the inbox and messages.

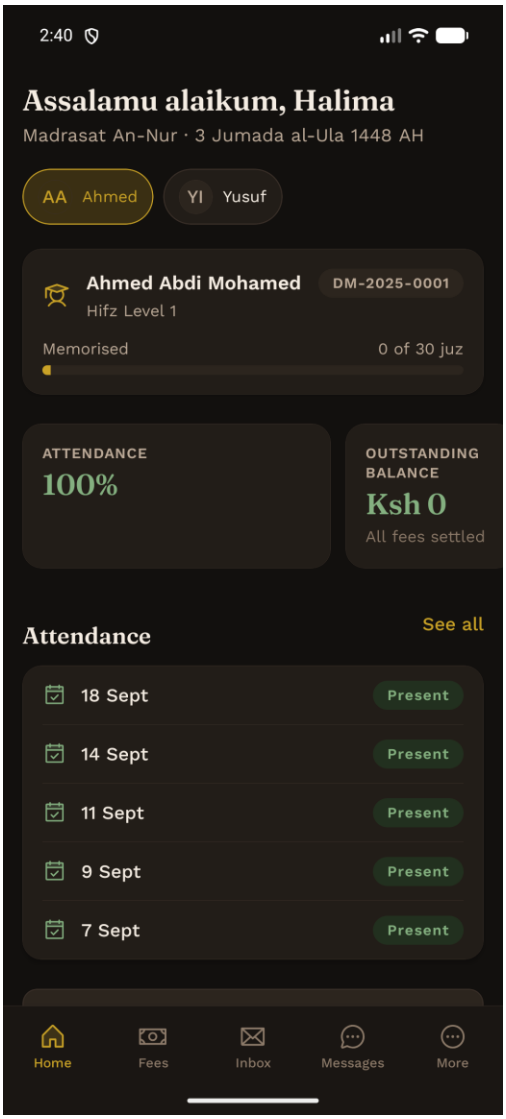


Figure 6.6 Parent Dashboard

Student Interface

The student's dashboard (Figure 6.7) shows the passages due for revision with a button to start a recitation, the juz memorised, attendance, overall progress and assignments.

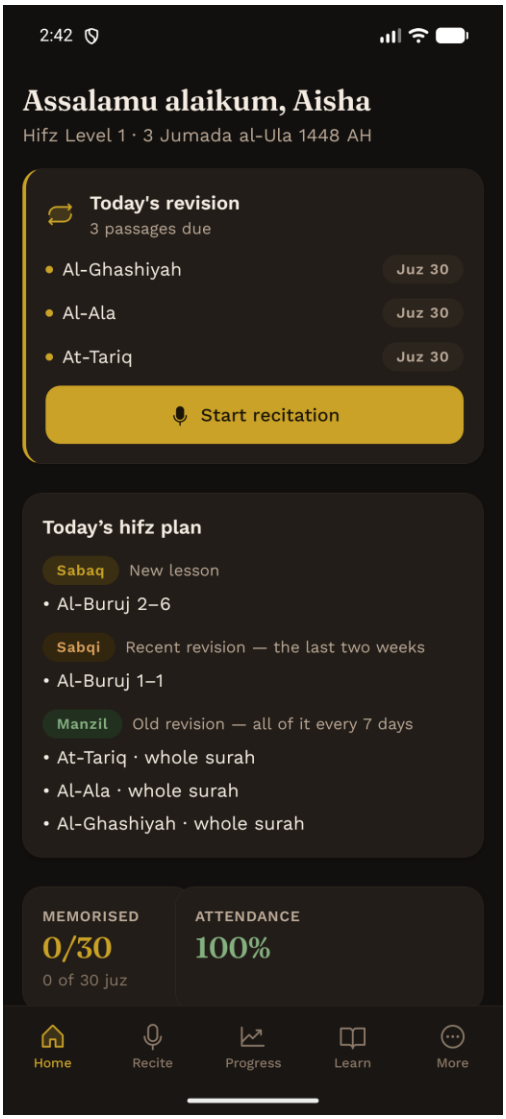
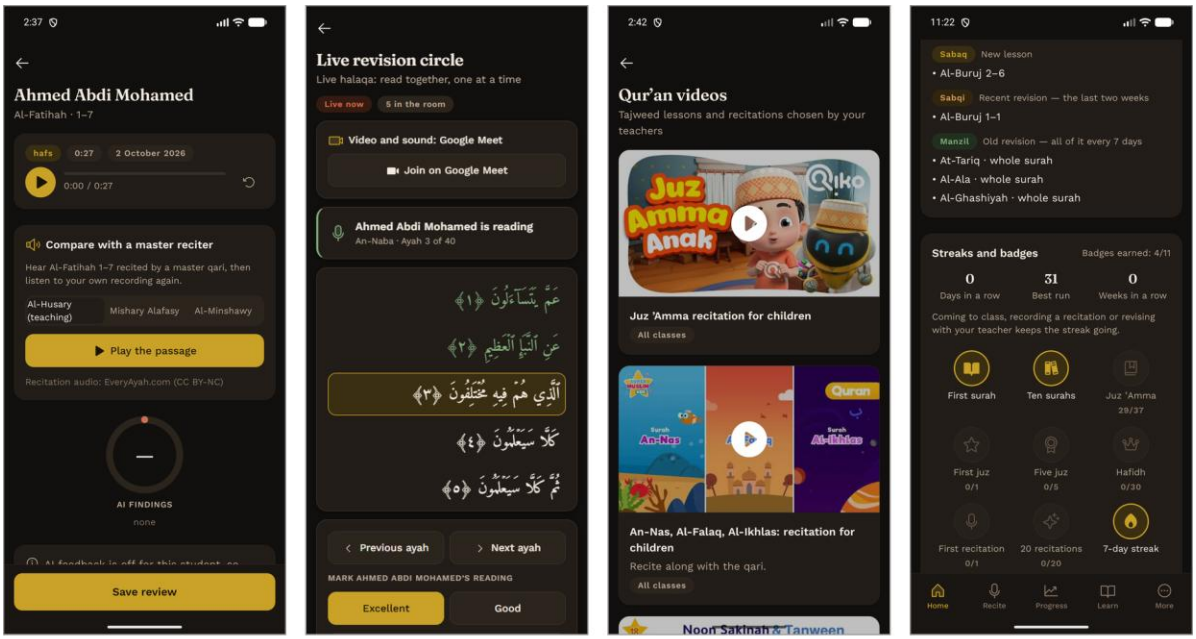


Figure 6.7 Student Dashboard

Recitation, Live Learning and Badge Interfaces

Figure 6.8 shows the learning features. A teacher reviewing a recitation can play the pupil and a master reciter ayah by ayah; in the live reading room pupils raise their hands, the teacher chooses a reader, the ayah is highlighted on every phone and the teacher marks the reading; the video library plays the Quran videos the teacher has chosen for the class; and badges, worked out from the pupil's own records, encourage the pupil.

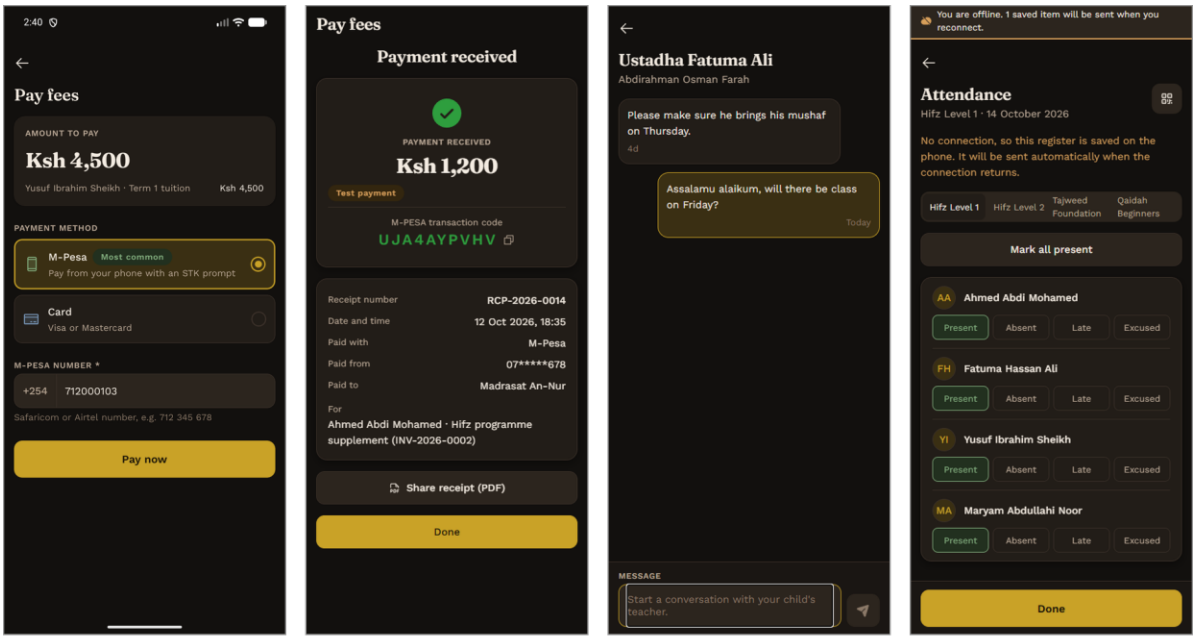


(a) Master reciter (b) Reading room (c) Quran videos (d) Badges

Figure 6.8 Recitation, Live Learning and Badge Interfaces

Payment, Messaging and Offline Interfaces

Figure 6.9 shows the parent paying a fee by M-Pesa, the receipt with its M-Pesa transaction code, a conversation between a parent and a teacher, and the attendance register saved on the phone while offline and sent when the connection returns.



(a) M-Pesa (b) Receipt (c) Messaging (d) Offline

Figure 6.9 Payment, Messaging and Offline Interfaces

6.4 Challenges Encountered During Development

Several challenges arose during development and were addressed as follows.

6.4.1 Technical Complexities

Supporting many madrasas and four roles in one system required every rule about who may see what to be written into the database as Row Level Security policies, and tested with accounts for every role. Performance testing showed that the original rule for reading a child's records became slower as the platform grew, so it was rewritten to be evaluated once per query and proven by a test to allow exactly the same records. Handling money also required care: the app never sends an amount, and a payment is settled on the server exactly once. Some features cannot be tested in Expo Go and needed an installable build; testing that build revealed that Arabic headings were drawn on the wrong side because React Native swaps left and right in a right-to-left layout, which was then fixed. A general AI model also had to be kept honest: given silence and the expected text, one model reported a perfect recitation, so the audio is now first transcribed without the text and checked in code before any score is given. Later features raised further issues: a reading-room channel had to admit only the pupils, parents and teachers of that class, so access is decided by a database rule; and attendance saved without a connection was at first held back by the data library

until the network returned, so the register is now kept on the phone and sent automatically on reconnection.

6.4.2 User Adoption and Resistance

Some owners, teachers and parents have little experience with mobile applications and may prefer familiar paper registers. To encourage adoption the interfaces were kept simple, with large buttons and clear summaries, the application was translated into Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic, and payment uses M-Pesa, which families already use, or a card. AI feedback on a child's voice is off until a parent turns it on.

6.4.3 Economic Constraints

Limited resources affected the choice of tools. Free and open-source tools were used throughout: Expo, React Native, Visual Studio Code, the free tier of Supabase, the free tier of Google Gemini and Safaricom's free Daraja sandbox. The in-app video provider that was evaluated required a payment card, so live lessons use free Google Meet or Zoom links, and the video code was kept separate so it can be switched on when funding allows. Card payments, e-mail and SMS were developed against mock providers; the same code switches to the real services when credentials are configured.

6.4.4 Continuous Updates and Supports

Long-term use requires ongoing maintenance. Database changes are made through numbered migrations, automated checks run on every change pushed to GitHub, and the database is backed up every three days. Keeping Expo, React Native and Supabase up to date and responding to feedback from madrasas will keep the system reliable.

6.5 Summary

This chapter described the development of the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application (ILMORA): Visual Studio Code as the development environment, React Native with Expo for the front end, and Supabase for the database, authentication, storage and server functions. It presented the sign-up screen and the main interfaces, and discussed the challenges of technical complexity, user adoption, limited resources and continuous maintenance, together with how each was addressed.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7. SYSTEM TESTING AND DEPLOYMENT

7.1 Introduction

Testing and deployment are critical phases in the development of Digital Madrasa. Testing ensures that the application meets its functional and security requirements and gives owners, teachers, parents and students a reliable experience. Deployment makes the system available to its users. This chapter describes the testing carried out, its results, and how the system is deployed now and will be deployed in future.

7.2 System Testing and Validation

The system was tested at several levels: unit testing of individual functions, functional testing of complete features against the deployed backend as each role, and user interface testing of the screens. Because the most important requirement is that no madrasa can see another's records and no user can act outside their role, tests checked that forbidden actions are refused as well as that permitted ones succeed.

7.2.1 Unit Tests

Unit testing examines individual components in isolation. Unit tests were written with Vitest for the logic that does not need a server: input validation, QR token signing, M-Pesa and card payment handling, notification rules, memorisation totals, recitation assessment, the AI assistant's check on figures, the hifz plan, master-reciter timing, video links, the offline attendance queue, and streaks and badges. All 185 unit tests in 23 test files passed when run on 16 October 2026. Table 7.1 shows representative cases.

Test Case ID	Module	Test Case Description	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT01	Validation	A payment request that includes an amount	Amount removed; server derives it	As expected	Pass
UT02	QR tokens	Token from an old window, or forged	Token rejected	As expected	Pass

Test Case ID	Module	Test Case Description	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT03	M-Pesa callback	Customer cancels the payment prompt	Recorded as failed; nothing credited	As expected	Pass
UT04	Memorisation	Overlapping memorisation records	Each juz counted once	As expected	Pass
UT05	Notifications	User has switched SMS off	No SMS sent	As expected	Pass
UT06	Video library	A link that is not from YouTube	Link refused	As expected	Pass
UT07	Offline queue	Register saved with no connection	Kept on the phone; sent once on reconnect	As expected	Pass

Table 7.1 Unit Testing

7.2.2 Functional Testing

Functional testing verifies that each feature works as the requirements specify. Scripts signed in as test accounts for every role and called the deployed backend; in total 78 functional test cases were run and all passed. In addition, 21 database verification suites, run against the live database on 15 October 2026, proved 145 security guarantees, such as that a parent sees only their own children and that a pupil cannot join another class's reading room; all passed. Key functionalities tested include:

- Sign-in and role-based access: each role reaches its own dashboard and is refused actions of other roles.
- Attendance, invoicing, M-Pesa and card payment, notifications, written work, certificates, and AI recitation feedback only with consent.
- Live lessons, the reading room, the video library, parent–teacher messaging, sponsorship and the impact dashboard, each limited to the right madrasa, class and role.

Test Case ID	Feature	Test Scenario	Expected Outcome	Actual Outcome	Status
FT01	Admission	Owner admits a student; a parent tries to	Number DM-YYYY-NNNN issued; parent refused	As expected	Pass

Test Case ID	Feature	Test Scenario	Expected Outcome	Actual Outcome	Status
FT02	QR attendance	Student scans a valid code, then an expired one	Marked present once; expired code refused	As expected	Pass
FT03	Invoicing	Owner issues invoices to one class	One invoice per student of that class	As expected	Pass
FT04	M-Pesa payment	Parent pays an invoice	Invoice paid; receipt issued; parent notified	As expected	Pass
FT05	AI feedback	Recitation from a pupil without parental consent	Nothing sent to the AI; no score given	As expected	Pass
FT06	M-Pesa failure	Customer cancels or lacks funds	Payment failed with the reason; invoice still due	As expected	Pass
FT07	Messaging	Parent writes to a teacher of another child	Message refused	As expected	Pass

Table 7.2 Functional Testing

7.2.3 User Interface (UI) Testing

User interface testing checks that the application is easy to use and visually consistent. It was carried out on an Android emulator, in the web build at phone size, and finally on the installed Android package (APK) built by Expo Application Services. Key areas tested were:

- Navigation: tabs and buttons lead to the correct screens for each role.
- Forms and input fields: admission, invoice and payment forms validate input and show clear messages.
- Languages: labels fit and read correctly in English, Kiswahili, Somali and Arabic.
- Visual consistency: fonts, colours, icons and buttons are consistent across screens.
- Offline use: with the connection cut, the last screens stay visible and the attendance register is saved on the phone, then sent when the connection returns.

On the installed app, recording, the offline library with the network switched off, the mirrored Arabic layout, camera permissions, confirmation dialogs, the AI assistant, parental consent and card payment were all exercised. Six defects found during UI testing were fixed: the parent inbox failed to display some notification types; tab labels were cut off in some languages; Arabic headings were drawn on the wrong side; the scanner did not notice a camera permission granted

in Settings; the microphone message was not translated; and an unassessed recording was praised. Push notifications remain to be verified, because they need a Firebase project to be configured.

Test Case ID	UI Element	Test Scenario	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UI01	Sign-in screen	Layout at phone size	Clean and responsive	As expected	Pass
UI02	Dashboard	Role-based display	Correct dashboard per role	As expected	Pass
UI03	Arabic layout	Installed app in Arabic	Screens mirrored right to left	As expected after fix	Pass
UI04	Forms	Data entry and validation	Easy input and clear feedback	As expected	Pass
UI05	Inbox	Display of notifications	All notices shown correctly	As expected after fix	Pass

Table 7.3 User Interface Testing

7.3 Testing Results

Testing produced positive results across all major parts of the system. Table 7.4 summarises the results. Of the 31 user interface checks, 30 passed, six of them after a defect was fixed; push notifications are still to be verified once Firebase is configured. In-app video was not tested because it is switched off.

Testing Type	Total Test Cases	Passed	Failed	Success Rate
Unit Testing	185	185	0	100%
Functional Testing	78	78	0	100%
Database Security Guarantees	145	145	0	100%
UI Testing	31	30	0	100% of tests run (1 pending)

Table 7.4 Testing Results

7.4 System Deployment

Deployment prepares the system for real use. The backend of Digital Madrasa is deployed on a hosted Supabase project: the database with its 41 migrations and security policies, private storage

for recitation audio, and 18 Edge Functions for operations such as invoicing, M-Pesa payments, notifications, AI feedback, spoken reports, USSD and the AI assistant. Automated checks run on GitHub for every change, and the database is backed up every three days.

7.4.1 Current Deployment Methods

The mobile application is built as an installable Android package (APK) with Expo Application Services (EAS) and connects to the live backend. The APK is distributed directly:

- Direct APK sharing: the APK file is shared through Google Drive, Bluetooth or USB, and users install it by allowing installation from unknown sources.
- WhatsApp distribution: the APK is shared as a document on WhatsApp, which madrasa owners, teachers and parents already use.
- Web: the same codebase is published on Expo's free hosting at https://https-ilmora-expo-app.expo.app, where the administrator's console runs.

7.4.2 Future Deployment Plans

- Google Play Store: publishing the app will make installation easier and more trusted, and provide automatic updates.
- Live payment and messaging services: moving M-Pesa from the Daraja sandbox to a registered Paybill or Till, and connecting Paystack for cards, the e-mail and SMS providers, and Firebase for push notifications, with real credentials.
- In-app video: switching on the built in-app video for live lessons once a funded video provider account is available.

7.5 Summary

This chapter presented the testing and deployment of the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application (ILMORA). Unit, functional, database security and user interface testing showed that the core features, including sign-in, admission, attendance, invoicing, M-Pesa and card payment, AI feedback with consent and parent access, work as required on the installed app, and that users cannot reach records outside their madrasa or role. The backend runs on Supabase, the app is shared as an APK and a website, and future plans include the Play Store, live payments and in-app video.

CHAPTER EIGHT

8. DISCUSSIONS, FUTURE WORKS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

8.1 Introduction

This chapter reflects on the outcomes of Digital Madrasa in relation to the objectives of the project. It evaluates how far the system addresses the challenges of madrasa administration and Quran learning in Kenya, and identifies future work and recommendations.

8.2 Discussions of Objectives

Objective 1

The project analysed the challenges facing madrasas in Kenya: informal and unstandardised records, limited parental visibility, the workload of assessing recitation, and fees that are not linked to invoices. The system addresses them with digital records of admission, attendance and memorisation, parent access approved by the madrasa, recorded recitations for teacher review, and invoices with M-Pesa payment. The questionnaire results in Chapter Four are to be completed from the fieldwork.

Objective 2

The review of existing systems showed that Quran applications serve individual learners while education management systems have no Quran-specific functions, and that none keeps many independent madrasas separate. Digital Madrasa combines both in one platform, with each madrasa's records isolated by the database and an interface in four languages.

Objective 3

The system was developed with React Native and Expo for the front end and Supabase for the backend. Owners, teachers, parents and students each have a dedicated dashboard, and admission, classes, manual and QR attendance, memorisation, assignments, recitation review with AI feedback, certificates, invoicing, M-Pesa and card payment, and notifications were implemented against the live backend. The application, branded ILMORA, also offers master-reciter comparison, recite-along practice, a daily hifz plan, hifz streaks and badges, a web console for the platform administrator, a live reading room with scheduled Meet or Zoom sessions, a teacher-

chosen Quran video library, parent–teacher messaging, pupil sponsorship, spoken reports, USSD access, offline attendance and an impact dashboard.

Objective 4

Unit, functional and user interface testing confirmed that the core features work as required: all 185 unit tests and 78 functional test cases passed, 21 database suites proved 145 security guarantees, and the installed app passed 30 of 31 interface checks. M-Pesa is connected to Safaricom's Daraja sandbox. The tests showed that users cannot reach records outside their madrasa or role. A usability study with real users, push notifications and testing on a range of physical phones remain to be done.

8.3 Future Work

Although the system meets its main objectives, several enhancements would improve its reach and usefulness.

8.3.1 Deployment to Google Play Store

Building the Android package and publishing the app on the Google Play Store would make installation easier and more trusted, provide automatic updates and allow feedback to be collected from users.

8.3.2 Development of Web-Based Admin Dashboard

The platform administrator's web console is now hosted and shows every madrasa, the platform's impact and an audit log. It should be extended with downloadable reports and subscription management, so that the madrasas on the platform, their subscriptions and their activity can be monitored and acted on from a browser.

8.3.3 Integration of Push Notifications and Messaging

Push, e-mail and SMS notifications and parent–teacher messaging are built. Configuring a Firebase project for push, connecting the real e-mail and SMS providers, a registered M-Pesa Paybill and Paystack, switching on in-app video for live lessons when a video provider can be funded, and confirming delivery on physical phones would give parents timely alerts about attendance, fees and reviews.

8.3.4 Smart Alerts and Recommendations

The daily hifz plan and the teacher's co-pilot already point to passages due for revision and to learners who fall behind. These could be extended into reminders based on spaced repetition (Kornell, 2009), and the general AI model now used for recitation feedback could be replaced with a tajweed model validated, with consent, on recordings of Kenyan learners.

8.3.5 Enhanced Offline Functionality

Many madrasas have unreliable internet access. Attendance can already be marked offline and is sent when the connection returns, and USSD serves parents with basic phones. Extending this to memorisation records and recordings would make the system fully usable in such areas.

8.4 Recommendations

To ensure the long-term success and adoption of the system, the following recommendations are proposed.

8.4.1 Continuous User Engagement

Feedback should be collected regularly from owners, teachers, parents and students, beginning with a pilot in one madrasa, so that the system continues to meet real needs.

8.4.2 Strengthening Data Security

Because the system holds children's records, authorisation must remain in the database, every change to an access rule should be tested before deployment, and the Kenya Data Protection Act 2019 must be followed.

8.4.3 Regular System Updates

The application should be updated regularly to fix defects, keep Expo, React Native and Supabase current, and add features requested by users.

8.4.4 Institutional and Government Collaboration

Collaboration with madrasa associations and the Ministry of Education would support adoption and help align the system's records with the planned integration of madrasa education into the national system (Kihaki, 2026; Tongola, 2025).

8.4.5 Optimization for Low-End Devices

The application should be optimised for the low-cost smartphones common among families, by reducing its size and data usage and testing it on such devices.

8.5 Summary

This chapter discussed how the Digital Madrasa Mobile Application (ILMORA) addressed the challenges of madrasa administration and Quran learning in Kenya. The system brings records, attendance, memorisation, recitation review, parent access and fee payment into one secure platform. Future work includes publishing on the Google Play Store, reports in the web console, live notifications and payments, in-app video, smart revision alerts and fuller offline support, while the recommendations emphasise user engagement, data security, regular updates, institutional collaboration and optimisation for low-end devices.

Appendix

A.1: User Survey Questionnaire

Section A: Madrasa Owner and Teacher Questionnaire

Question 1: How is student attendance currently recorded in your madrasa?

☐ Exercise book or register

☐ Wall chart

☐ Teacher's memory only

☐ Not recorded

☐ Other (please specify): _____

Question 2: How is a student's Quran memorisation progress recorded?

☐ Written in a book

☐ Teacher remembers

☐ Told to the parent verbally

☐ Not recorded

☐ Other (please specify): _____

Question 3: How are fees recorded and communicated to parents?

☐ Written receipt book

☐ Verbal reminder

☐ M-Pesa messages only

☐ No formal record

☐ Other (please specify): _____

Section B: Parent Questionnaire

Question 1: How do you currently learn about your child's attendance and progress?

☐ Told at pick-up

☐ Phone call from the teacher

☐ Parents' meeting

☐ I am not informed

☐ Other (please specify): _____

Question 2: Would you pay madrasa fees through M-Pesa in a mobile application?

☐ Yes

☐ Maybe

☐ No

Section C: Student Questionnaire

Question 1: How does your teacher assess your recitation?

☐ I recite to the teacher in class

☐ The teacher listens to a group together

☐ Rarely assessed

☐ Other (please specify): _____

Question 2: Would recording your recitation on a phone help you practise?

☐ Strongly agree

☐ Agree

☐ Neutral

☐ Disagree

☐ Strongly disagree

A.2: Work Plan and Schedule

Task	Start Date	End Date	Duration	Development Description
Requirement Gathering	[INSERT DATE]	[INSERT DATE]	[INSERT]	Identify user roles and madrasa requirements; literature review
System Design & Wireframing	[INSERT DATE]	[INSERT DATE]	[INSERT]	Diagrams, database schema and wireframes
Supabase Setup & Core Platform	[INSERT DATE]	2026-08-23	[INSERT]	Multi-tenant database, authentication and screens for all roles
Edge Functions, CI & Backups	2026-08-24	2026-09-16	24 days	Server functions, build configuration, automated checks and backups
Backend Integration & Recitation	2026-09-17	2026-09-23	7 days	Live backend, recitation storage, teacher review and parent access

Task	Start Date	End Date	Duration	Development Description
QR Attendance & Invoicing	2026-09-23	2026-09-24	2 days	Rotating QR attendance and targeted invoices
Learning, Payments & Notifications	2026-09-25	2026-09-29	5 days	Written work, certificates, M-Pesa payments, notifications and translations
System Testing & Validation	2026-09-19	2026-09-30	12 days	Unit, functional, user interface and performance testing
Final Documentation & Deployment	2026-09-30	[INSERT DATE]	[INSERT]	Report, APK build and presentation

Table 8.1: Work Plan and Schedule

A.3: Budget

Items	Quantity	Cost (KES)	Total Cost (KES)	Notes
Internet data bundles	3 months	2,000	6,000	Development, testing and backend access
Transport & field data collection	–	–	4,000	Visiting madrasas for questionnaires and interviews
Printing, binding & documentation	–	–	3,500	Final report copies
Google Play developer registration	1	3,250	3,250	One-time US$ 25, when the app is published
Supabase backend services	1	0	0	Free plan
M-Pesa, e-mail & SMS services	–	–	0	Mock providers during development; pay per use when live
Development tools (VS Code, Expo, GitHub)	–	0	0	Free and open source
Test device (Android phone)	1	[INSERT]	[INSERT]	Existing device, or cost if purchased
Contingency (unexpected costs)	–	–	1,675	10% of paid items
Total Estimated Budget			18,425	Plus a test device if purchased

Table 8.2: Budget

A.4: My Project Repository

Repository link: [INSERT GITHUB REPOSITORY LINK]

[INSERT SCREENSHOT HERE]

GitHub repository home page after the final push

A.5: Plagiarism Report

[INSERT PLAGIARISM REPORT HERE]

Similarity report issued by the university's plagiarism checker

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